SOFTWARE BLUEPRINT · PHASE 2

Business Requirements

Objectives, operating model and business requirements for the bounded general merchandise marketplace

Working name only — no Usiri affiliation is implied.

Prepared for: the founding group
Document: UM-BRD-001 · **Version:** 1.0
Date: 30 October 2026
Baseline: UM-DISC-001 v0.2 · UM-AMD-001 v1.0

DRAFT FOR APPROVAL. No implementation is authorized. Usiri is a potential logistics and brand partner, not a confirmed one. No API, rate card, franchise term or licence is assumed.

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0. Document control

Field	Value
Document	Business Requirements Document
Project	Usiri Marketplace (working name)
Document ID	UM-BRD-001
Version	1.0
Status	**Draft for founder review. No implementation is authorized.**
Date	30 October 2026
Prepared for	The founding group
Prepared by	Project initiator, acting as business analyst and software architect
Classification	Confidential — internal discussion
Baseline	UM-DISC-001 Requirements Discovery Report v0.2; UM-AMD-001 Scope Amendment v1.0; UM-DEC-001 Decision Log v0.2
Next document	UM-SRS-001 Software Requirements Specification

> **Status notice.** Usiri Group of Companies is a **potential** logistics and brand partner. No approval, API, rate card, franchise term or brand licence is assumed. The platform is designed to work with any qualified carrier and any licensed payment service provider. No code has been written.

0.1 How this document is used

The BRD states **what the business needs and why**, in business language. It does not prescribe screens, schemas or endpoints; those belong to the SRS, the architecture and the UX specification. Every business need carries an ID so that the SRS and the test plan can trace back to it. Evidence labels follow the discovery report: **[Confirmed]**, **[Assumption]**, **[Proposed]**, **[Open]**.

1. Executive summary

The proposed marketplace lets customers in Dar es Salaam buy from many verified suppliers in one checkout, pay through a licensed payment provider, and receive a tracked delivery. Suppliers keep their stock and their shop; the platform supplies demand, catalogue discipline, delivery coordination, payment reconciliation and customer care. The platform earns commission on completed merchandise and a coordination margin on delivery. It does not buy inventory, hold customer funds or operate a fleet.

The founders decided on 30 October 2026 to launch with **general merchandise**, bounded to six departments, rather than the narrower home-and-kitchen pilot originally recommended. The decision increases the size of the opportunity to be tested and increases the operational load: variants, category attributes, category-specific returns, authenticity controls and higher moderation volume all become launch requirements.

The business test is narrow and measurable. Within six months of launch the platform must show that customers will buy across suppliers, that delivery can be trusted, that failures are resolved fairly, that suppliers stay, and that each order contributes a positive margin. If those five things are not true, the platform should change or stop; it should not scale.

This document defines the business requirements for that test. It is the basis for the SRS, the architecture and the test plan, and it records what remains unresolved.

2. Business context

2.1 The problem being solved

A customer in Dar es Salaam who wants a set of household, fashion or baby items faces a fragmented market. She must visit several shops or several Instagram and WhatsApp sellers, negotiate delivery separately, pay without a receipt, and accept that a wrong size or a damaged item may not be exchangeable. A small supplier faces the mirror image: reach depends on foot traffic or on social media effort, delivery is ad hoc, and there is no affordable way to look trustworthy to a new customer.

The marketplace addresses both sides with one promise: **many verified shops, one checkout, one delivery coordination point, and a return path that works**.

2.2 What is known and what is not

Area	What the evidence supports	What remains unproven
Demand	Urban households buy these categories online and through social commerce; competitors operate in Dar es Salaam	Willingness to buy across suppliers in one basket; sensitivity to a minimum basket
Supply	Small and medium shops exist in the target categories and lack digital reach	Willingness to accept commission, payout delay and catalogue discipline
Delivery	Licensed couriers operate in the city; address quality is uneven	Cost per parcel by category; first-attempt success; liability terms
Payments	Mobile money is dominant; licensed PSPs serve merchants	PSP settlement product, fees and refund behaviour
Usiri	A logistics and brand business exists	Any partnership, API, rate card or licence

The concept document, the discovery report and the workbook hold the supporting detail. This BRD does not upgrade any assumption into a fact.

2.3 Why a managed marketplace rather than a shop or a reseller

A managed marketplace keeps capital light and lets the platform test demand across categories without owning stock. It also creates a trust role that a classifieds site does not: the platform verifies suppliers, moderates listings, coordinates delivery, and stands behind the return process. That trust role is the product. It is also the cost centre, which is why the operating model must be explicit about who does what.

2.4 What “general merchandise” means in this project

It means a **multi-department consumer assortment of six bounded departments**, not an unlimited catalogue:

1. Homeware, storage and kitchenware
2. Small kitchen and home appliances
3. Fashion and footwear
4. Beauty and personal care
5. Baby and maternity
6. Home and kitchen bundles

Consumer electronics and phones, groceries, furniture, building materials and restricted goods are excluded from launch. The boundary is a condition of a safe launch. It is recorded in UM-AMD-001 and is a founder decision, not a vendor preference.

3. Business objectives and success measures

3.1 Objectives

ID	Objective	Why it matters	Measure and target	Review
OBJ-01	Prove that customers will buy from several verified suppliers through one checkout	Demand is the first risk; without orders nothing else can be tested	900 completed orders in pilot month 6; at least 30% of orders contain two or more suppliers	Monthly
OBJ-02	Deliver reliably enough that customers trust the platform with repeat purchases	A late or lost parcel destroys trust faster than price attracts it	At least 90% on-time delivery; first-attempt success at least 80%	Weekly
OBJ-03	Resolve failures fairly and quickly	The first exception is the moment of truth	90% of complaints resolved within 48 hours; returns below 5% of delivered orders	Weekly
OBJ-04	Recruit and retain credible suppliers	Supply quality determines catalogue quality and returns	40 verified suppliers by month 3; 80% retention after 90 days	Monthly
OBJ-05	Prove positive contribution economics	Growth on negative unit economics destroys the company faster	Contribution at least 4% of gross order value by month 6	Monthly
OBJ-06	Operate within Tanzanian law and the platform’s contracts	A compliance failure can stop trading and damage the brand	Written legal baseline; registrations and filings completed as advised	Before launch
OBJ-07	Run the pilot with a small team without operational chaos	The team, not the software, is the constraint at launch	Every pilot order handled through the system; no shadow spreadsheets for money	Weekly
OBJ-08	Produce evidence for a scale, pivot or stop decision	The pilot exists to buy information, not to prove a point	Documented go/no-go review at month 6	Month 6

3.2 Guardrails

The objectives are not to be met by trading away the foundations:

- **No order without a verified supplier.** Growth in supplier count never outpaces verification capacity.
- **No delivery promise without a carrier commitment.** The promise is set from measured performance, not ambition.
- **No customer money outside the PSP.** The platform does not hold funds, lend, or operate a wallet.
- **No commission before the customer is served.** Revenue is recognised on completed merchandise, not on captured payment.
- **No silent exception.** Every manual override, refund, payout hold and safety suspension carries an actor, a reason and a record.

3.3 Measurement discipline

Targets in this document are **hypotheses to be baselined**, not commitments. The first four weeks of operation establish the baseline for conversion, basket size, delivery success, return rate and support volume. Targets are then reviewed against that baseline at the first monthly business review, and any change is recorded in the decision log. Vanity metrics — page views, app installs, follower counts — are not acceptance measures.

4. Scope

4.1 In scope for the first release

- A mobile-first customer web experience in Swahili and English, with guest checkout and optional accounts.
- A catalogue of six departments with product variants, category attributes, size guides, moderation and category-specific return rules.
- A supplier portal for onboarding, documents, catalogue, stock, orders, dispatch, statements and performance.
- An operations console for verification, moderation, orders, payments, payouts, logistics, returns, disputes, support and reporting.
- A logistics coordination capability that works manually at launch and is provider-agnostic.
- Payment through a licensed PSP with verification, refunds, reconciliation and supplier payouts.
- Category-sensitive returns and a support workflow with order context.
- Role-based access, audit logging, configuration, and the legal pages required at checkout.

4.2 Launch profile

Dimension	Launch position	Basis
City	Dar es Salaam mainland	[Confirmed]
Currency and tax	TZS; tax treatment configurable and unresolved	[Assumption] / [Open]
Departments	Six bounded departments	[Confirmed] D-01
Suppliers	40 verified at launch; 60 by month 6	[Assumption]
Active SKUs	800–1,200	[Assumption]
Orders	900 completed orders in month 6	[Assumption]

Dimension	Launch position	Basis
Commission	8% hypothesis, configurable and effective-dated	[Assumption]
Delivery charge	TZS 5,000 hypothesis, category and zone aware	[Assumption]
Minimum basket	TZS 30,000 or a small-order fee, to be tested	[Open] D-14
Support	09:00–18:00 Monday–Saturday	[Proposed]

4.3 Out of scope for the first release

Native mobile applications; marketplace warehouse or dark store; marketplace fleet; real-time GPS tracking; customer wallet, credit or instalments; buyer-seller chat; multi-city operations; international shipping and multi-currency; AI recommendations; automated supplier payouts; microservices and event streaming; advertising auction and loyalty programme.

4.4 Scope change rule

A capability enters the first release only if it is required to complete, deliver, refund or support a pilot order, or to meet a legal obligation. Everything else is deferred, however attractive. Any exception requires a written change note approved by the founders, with the schedule or quality consequence stated.

5. Stakeholders and roles

5.1 Stakeholder register

IDs STK-01 to STK-16 follow UM-DISC-001. STK-17 to STK-19 are added by this BRD for commercial parties that the baseline treats as dependencies rather than users.

ID	Stakeholder	What they need	What the platform needs from them
STK-01	Guest visitor	Browse and understand price, delivery and returns before committing	Lawful use; accurate contact details at checkout
STK-02	Registered customer	Reliable purchase, tracking, returns and help	Accurate address and contact; payment
STK-03	Individual merchant	More sales without a delivery desk	Accurate listings, current stock, standard packing
STK-04	Business supplier	A predictable channel that protects its reputation	Contract compliance, quality, fulfilment discipline
STK-05	Supplier employee	Clear daily tasks without sensitive data	Correct packing and dispatch updates
STK-06	Logistics provider	Profitable, predictable parcel volume	Pickup, line-haul, delivery, status events, claims
STK-07	Logistics agent or driver	Clear stops and proof of delivery	Delivery, status events, proof of delivery
STK-08	Customer support agent	Full context to resolve issues	Fair, documented decisions
STK-09	Finance personnel	Accurate money and clean reconciliation	Timely review and approval
STK-10	Catalogue moderator	A trustworthy, accurate catalogue	Consistent review against the checklist

ID	Stakeholder	What they need	What the platform needs from them
STK-11	Operations administrator	Orders move and exceptions close	Timely booking and exception handling
STK-12	Super administrator	The platform is controlled and auditable	Least-privilege discipline
STK-13	Franchise or brand manager	Brand standards and licence compliance	Nothing until a written licence exists
STK-14	Technology administrator	A secure, available system	Patch, monitor and restore discipline
STK-15	Auditor or adviser	Evidence that controls work	Independent review
STK-16	Regulators and authorities	Compliance with applicable law	Registration and cooperation
STK-17	Payment service provider	Compliant merchants and clean transaction data	Contractual compliance; accurate references
STK-18	Usiri, potentially	A credible operating partner and brand licensor	Nothing is assumed until a written agreement
STK-19	Investors or lenders, potentially	Evidence of traction and unit economics	Nothing is assumed

5.2 Internal role model

Fourteen roles are defined in the discovery report (ROL-01 to ROL-14). For business purposes they collapse into five accountability groups:

Group	Roles	Accountable for
Customer-facing	Guest, customer	Their own account and orders
Supply-facing	Supplier owner, supplier staff	Their own catalogue, stock and fulfilment
Logistics-facing	Carrier administrator, agent or driver	Assigned shipments and delivery evidence
Platform operations	Support, moderator, category lead, operations lead	Catalogue quality, customer resolution, delivery coordination
Control functions	Finance, administrator, auditor, founder	Money, access, audit and direction

5.3 Decision rights

Decision	Recommends	Approves	Informed
Supplier approval and suspension	Operations lead	Founder	Finance
Listing approval and rejection	Moderator	Category lead	Supplier
Refund within limit	Support agent	Finance	Customer
Refund above limit	Finance	Founder	Customer
Payout batch	Finance preparer	Second finance approver or founder	Suppliers
Carrier selection and rates	Operations lead	Founder	Finance
Commission and fee change	Founder	Founder	Suppliers, finance
Category addition or removal	Category lead	Founder	Operations, finance

Decision	Recommends	Approves	Informed
Brand or franchise configuration activation	Founder	Written licence holder	All staff
Safety recall and listing suspension	Category lead	Founder or duty manager	Customers affected, supplier

Separation of duties is a requirement, not a preference: the person who prepares a payout does not approve it, and the person who approves a listing does not verify the supplier’s bank account.

6. Target operating model

6.1 Supply

Suppliers hold their own stock and pack their own orders. The platform verifies the supplier’s identity, business registration, tax registration, shop location and payout account before the first listing is approved. Verification is re-performed on a schedule and on any change of ownership or bank account. Suppliers receive a portal, a packing standard, a performance scorecard and a settlement statement.

The platform does not buy stock, set prices unilaterally, or take ownership of inventory. It does set listing standards, commission, delivery charges and service levels, and it can suspend a listing or a supplier for safety, fraud or repeated failure.

6.2 Demand

Demand is generated through search, category browsing, supplier storefronts and controlled promotions. The customer experience is mobile-first and Swahili-first. Guest checkout is allowed because registration friction is a known cause of abandonment in the market; an account is offered after the first order. Reviews come only from verified purchasers.

6.3 Order and delivery

One checkout creates one parent order and one supplier order per supplier. Each supplier order is fulfilled separately and may ship separately, so a three-supplier basket produces up to three parcels. The customer sees one order with a per-supplier progress view, not three unrelated orders.

The platform coordinates pickup through licensed carriers. At launch the coordination is manual (Mode A): an operator books the carrier, records the waybill, and updates status from carrier messages. The data recorded is identical to what an integrated carrier would supply, so an API can be added later without changing the order model. Delivery charges are quoted per shipment, displayed before payment, and allocated to the supplier order that generated them.

6.4 Money

A licensed PSP collects the customer’s payment. The platform records a payable to each supplier equal to merchandise value less commission and less any supplier-funded discount, and a separate carrier payable. The supplier payable becomes eligible for payout after delivery plus the return window, subject to holds for disputes, negative balances or KYC issues.

The platform's own revenue is commission plus the coordination margin between the customer delivery charge and the carrier charge. Pass-through money is never counted as revenue. No customer funds are held outside the PSP, and the platform is not described as an escrow service.

6.5 Service

Customer support runs during published hours and works from order context, not from memory. Every ticket links to an order, a supplier order and, where relevant, a shipment. Refunds above a threshold require finance approval. The support standard is a first human response within four working hours and resolution of 90% of complaints within 48 hours.

6.6 Catalogue and category management

Each department has a category lead — initially a founder or the operations lead wearing a category hat — who owns the assortment, the attribute template, the moderation checklist and the return rules. Moderation is a queue with reasons and resubmission, not an inbox. Listings are audited after publication, and a prohibited-item list is maintained as configuration.

The platform deliberately runs a **shallow but credible** catalogue: the best-selling, photographable, returnable range of each supplier, not its entire inventory. Depth is added after the first cohort proves it can list and fulfil well.

6.7 Capacity assumptions

The launch team is one operations lead, one part-time moderator, one support agent (shared with operations), one finance person (part-time) and the technical team. That capacity supports roughly 40 suppliers and 1,000 listings only if onboarding is phased. The business plan must not assume the same team can double supplier count without adding moderation capacity.

7. Business processes

ID	Process	Trigger	Outcome	Owner
WF-01	Customer purchase across suppliers	Customer checks out	Paid parent order with supplier orders and reservations	Operations
WF-02	Supplier fulfilment	Supplier order accepted	Packed parcel handed to carrier with waybill	Supplier
WF-03	Payment verification and reconciliation	PSP callback or daily file	Payment matched to order; exceptions queued	Finance
WF-04	Manual logistics (Mode A)	Supplier marks ready for pickup	Shipment booked, tracked and delivered with POD	Operations
WF-05	Integrated logistics (Mode B)	Carrier API available	Same records created through the adapter	Operations
WF-06	Returns, refunds and disputes	Customer request within window	Item returned or refund decided; supplier charged back	Support and finance
WF-07	Supplier onboarding and KYC	Supplier application	Verified supplier able to publish approved listings	Operations

ID	Process	Trigger	Outcome	Owner
WF-08	Support and escalation	Customer contact	Ticket resolved or escalated with a documented decision	Support

Process detail, including alternative paths and exception handling, is in the SRS use cases. The business rules that govern each process are in Section 9.

8. Business needs catalogue

Each need is a business outcome. The SRS converts it into testable software requirements.

ID	Business need	Capabilities	Success measure
BN-01	A customer can buy from several suppliers in one checkout and see one order	CAP-06, CAP-07	Multi-supplier orders complete without manual intervention
BN-02	Only verified, accountable suppliers can sell	CAP-02	100% of live suppliers have complete KYC evidence
BN-03	Products are described consistently enough to compare and return	CAP-03	95% of listings pass attribute completeness at first review
BN-04	Customers can find products quickly on a phone	CAP-05	Search success rate and zero-result rate monitored
BN-05	Price and stock shown are true at the moment of payment	CAP-04	Oversell rate below 0.5% of orders
BN-06	Delivery cost and promise are clear before payment	CAP-10	Delivery-related complaints below 5% of orders
BN-07	Payment is safe, verifiable and refundable	CAP-08	100% of payments matched or exceptioned within one day
BN-08	Suppliers are paid correctly and on time	CAP-09	Payout disputes below 1% of statements
BN-09	A partially fulfilled order is handled without cancelling the whole order	CAP-07	Partial cancellation and partial delivery supported end to end
BN-10	Returns follow category rules that are fair and published	CAP-11	Return decisions consistent with policy in audit sample
BN-11	Customers know where their parcel is	CAP-07, CAP-13	Tracking visible for 100% of shipments
BN-12	A customer can reach a human with order context	CAP-12	First response within four working hours
BN-13	Personal data is collected lawfully and minimally	CAP-01, CAP-14	Consent evidence for 100% of accounts
BN-14	Each role sees only what its job requires	CAP-01, CAP-14	Authorisation tests pass for every role
BN-15	Sensitive actions are reconstructable after the fact	CAP-14	100% of refunds, payouts and status changes audited
BN-16	Moderation capacity matches catalogue growth	CAP-03	Queue age under 48 hours during onboarding
BN-17	Supplier performance is measured objectively	CAP-15	Scorecards available monthly to every supplier
BN-18	A unsafe or recalled product can be removed and buyers notified	CAP-03, CAP-13	Recall executed within one working day
BN-19	Category profitability is visible	CAP-15	Contribution reported by department monthly

ID	Business need	Capabilities	Success measure
BN-20	Brand and franchise rules can be configured without code	CAP-18	Configuration change without deployment
BN-21	Promotions are controlled and funded deliberately	CAP-17	Every discount attributable to a campaign and a funder
BN-22	Reviews are trustworthy	CAP-16	Only verified purchases published
BN-23	Money reconciles to the ledger every day	CAP-08	Unmatched transactions below 0.5%
BN-24	Management can run the business from reports, not spreadsheets	CAP-15	Daily operating report used at stand-up
BN-25	The platform can grow without re-architecture	NFR-S-01, NFR-S-02	10x SKUs supported in design review
BN-26	The experience works in Swahili and English	NFR-I18N-01	No untranslated string in critical flows
BN-27	The business can recover from data loss or outage	NFR-R-02	Restore drill within target
BN-28	Founders can decide to scale, pivot or stop on evidence	CAP-15	Month-6 review pack complete

9. Business rules

The full rule catalogue is BR-001 to BR-040, held in the discovery report and the scope amendment. The BRD groups them by the business question they answer.

9.1 Orders and pricing

Rule	Statement	Status
BR-001	One checkout creates one parent order and one supplier order per supplier	Proposed
BR-003	Prices and totals are calculated server-side; the browser total is never authoritative	Proposed
BR-011	Placing an order snapshots title, SKU, price, tax line and commission rule	Proposed
BR-012	Cancellation is allowed before supplier acceptance; afterwards it becomes a return	Proposed
BR-019	Money is stored as integer TZS with explicit rounding applied once	Proposed
BR-038	A minimum delivered order value or small-order fee may apply, displayed before checkout	Open

9.2 Money and settlement

Rule	Statement	Status
BR-004	Commission is charged on net completed merchandise, not gross captured payment	Proposed

Rule	Statement	Status
BR-005	Customer delivery charge, carrier charge and coordination fee are separate amounts	Proposed
BR-006	Refunds may include item value and delivery share; change-of-mind refunds may exclude delivery	Open
BR-007	Supplier payout is held until delivery plus the return window, extended by dispute or risk	Proposed
BR-009	Every financial adjustment needs a reason, an actor and a second approver above threshold	Proposed
BR-021	The platform is not an escrow or deposit-taking service and holds no customer funds	Confirmed
BR-027	A refund cannot exceed captured amount less prior refunds and reversals	Proposed
BR-028	A payout batch needs a preparer and a different approver	Proposed
BR-029	Payouts may be held for open dispute, negative balance or unresolved KYC, with a written reason	Proposed

9.3 Catalogue and supply

Rule	Statement	Status
BR-010	A product is visible only after moderation approval and while stock is above zero	Proposed
BR-013	A supplier sees only the customer data needed to pack and hand over	Proposed
BR-015	Prohibited items are blocked at listing and removed at moderation; relisting leads to suspension	Proposed
BR-022	Brand, territory, fee and approval rules are configuration with effective dates	Confirmed
BR-033	Every purchasable item resolves to a variant with its own SKU, price and stock	Proposed
BR-034	A listing cannot publish until mandatory category attributes are complete	Proposed
BR-036	Beauty listings require authenticity evidence and, where applicable, batch or expiry data	Proposed
BR-037	Baby and maternity listings require safety declarations, age grading and recall checks	Proposed
BR-039	Category commission rates may differ, but a rate change applies only to future orders	Proposed
BR-040	A recall can suspend a listing and notify affected buyers without deleting order history	Proposed

9.4 Delivery and returns

Rule	Statement	Status
BR-008	A supplier cannot mark an order delivered; delivery needs carrier or operations evidence	Proposed
BR-016	Every shipment records carrier, service, waybill, cost, weight, dimensions, events and POD	Proposed
BR-017	Failed attempts follow a published retry policy with customer contact before retry	Proposed
BR-018	The return window starts at delivery and excludes hygiene or safety items where law allows	Open
BR-030	Carrier and supplier performance is measured from system events and visible to the party	Proposed
BR-031	A shipment can be run manually with the same records an API carrier would use	Confirmed
BR-035	Return eligibility and refund treatment are category-specific and published before purchase	Open

9.5 Trust, access and compliance

Rule	Statement	Status
BR-014	Only verified purchasers may review, once per purchased line, moderated for abuse	Proposed
BR-020	VAT and tax lines are stored per invoice line and configurable; no treatment is assumed	Open
BR-023	Audit records are append-only and cannot be edited through the application	Proposed
BR-024	Personal data is collected for a stated purpose and deleted or anonymised on schedule	Proposed
BR-025	Marketing consent is separate from transactional messages and withdrawable	Proposed
BR-026	Staff access outside normal duties needs a reason, is time-bound and logged	Proposed
BR-032	A customer can obtain a human response within published support hours	Proposed

Rules marked **Open** cannot be implemented as fixed policy. They are configurable, and the default is the most protective position that is commercially tolerable. Each open rule has an owner in the decision log.

10. Information requirements

10.1 Core business entities

Entity	Business meaning	Owner	Retention
Customer	A person who buys, with contact, addresses and consent	Platform	Active plus statutory period
Supplier	A verified seller with legal identity, contract and payout account	Platform	Contract plus statutory period
Supplier document	Registration, TIN, identity, site evidence, bank verification	Operations	As required by law and audit
Product and variant	What is sold, with attributes, media, price and stock	Supplier, moderated by platform	Life of listing plus order history
Parent order	The customer’s commercial order	Platform	Statutory period
Supplier order	The supplier’s obligation and settlement unit	Platform	Statutory period
Shipment	The physical movement of goods with carrier and proof	Platform	Statutory period
Payment and refund	Money received and returned through the PSP	Finance	Statutory period
Ledger entry	Every financial movement, with accounts and references	Finance	Statutory period
Payout	A batch payment to a supplier with approval evidence	Finance	Statutory period
Return and dispute	A claim, its evidence and its resolution	Support	Statutory period
Ticket	A customer contact and its resolution	Support	Policy period
Consent record	What was agreed, when, to which notice version	Platform	As required
Audit record	Who changed what, when and why	Platform	As required

10.2 Information qualities

- **Single source of truth.** Money is recorded in the ledger; order status is derived from events, not typed into a field.
- **Snapshot at transaction.** Order lines preserve what was sold at the price and terms agreed.
- **Minimisation.** The supplier sees delivery data, not customer history; the carrier sees the address, not the price.
- **Traceability.** Every financial and access event can be reconstructed from records.
- **Separation.** Customer funds, platform revenue and supplier payables are distinct accounts.

10.3 Reporting needs

Daily: orders, payments, exceptions, deliveries due, tickets open, payouts due. Weekly: delivery success, returns, supplier dispatch performance, catalogue queue. Monthly: contribution by department, supplier cohort retention, customer repeat rate, category mix, moderation throughput.

11. Legal and regulatory obligations

Area	Obligation in business terms	Status
Data protection (PDPA 2022, PDPC)	Lawful basis, notice, consent, access and deletion, security, registration where required	Counsel to confirm; REG-01
Consumer contracts (FCC Standard Form Regulations 2014)	Fair standard-form terms, clear pricing, complaint handling	Counsel to confirm; REG-02
Electronic transactions (ETA 2015)	Electronic records, signatures and evidence	Counsel to confirm; REG-03
Payment services (Bank of Tanzania)	Collection and settlement only through a licensed provider; no unauthorised deposit-taking	PSP and counsel; REG-04
Courier and postal services (TCRA)	Carriers must be licensed for the services used	Carrier due diligence; REG-05
Tax (TRA)	VAT and corporate tax treatment, invoices and records	Accountant and counsel; REG-06
Business registration (BRELA)	Company registration and filings	Company secretary; REG-07
Fair competition and consumer protection	Honest pricing, no misleading claims, fair supplier terms	Counsel; REG-08
Product safety and standards	Baby products, appliances, cosmetics, recalls	Category leads and counsel; REG-09 to REG-11
Employment and contractor law	Rider and staff engagement model	Counsel; REG-12

The platform does not assert that it complies until counsel has confirmed the position and the controls are evidenced. Compliance is a launch gate, not a post-launch task.

12. Assumptions, constraints and dependencies

12.1 Business assumptions

ID	Assumption	Test
A-01	Customers will pay online through a PSP	Observe payment success and abandonment in first cohort
A-02	Six departments can be supplied credibly by 40 suppliers	Supplier recruitment against department targets

ID	Assumption	Test
A-03	40 suppliers can deliver 800–1,200 active SKUs	Catalogue audit at launch
A-04	900 orders in month 6 is achievable at planned acquisition cost	Monthly acquisition and conversion tracking
A-05	8% commission is acceptable to suppliers	Contract negotiation and churn
A-06	TZS 5,000 delivery charge is viable with a minimum basket	Carrier quotes and basket data
A-07	A 7-day return window is workable across categories	Return rate and dispute data
A-08	Manual logistics can support launch volume	Shipments per operator per day
A-09	Support volume is manageable with one agent	Tickets per 100 orders
A-10	Suppliers will keep stock current	Weekly stock update rate
A-11	Moderation can be staffed part-time	Queue age during onboarding
A-12	Swahili-first is the right default	Language switching and support language mix
A-13	A minimum basket will not destroy conversion	Checkout test
A-14	8–12 weeks is achievable with the stated team	Week-8 gate

12.2 Constraints

- One city, one currency, one legal entity at launch.
- No platform-held customer funds.
- No hard-coded Usiri dependency; any carrier integration must be replaceable.
- No warehouse, fleet or inventory ownership.
- Small team; no 24/7 support at launch.
- Payment only through a licensed provider.
- Brand use only under a written licence.

12.3 Dependencies

Dependency	Needed by	Owner	Risk if late
PSP contract and sandbox	Before payment build	Finance lead	Payment cannot be built or tested
Carrier agreement and rate card	Before checkout pricing is frozen	Operations lead	Delivery promise and pricing unknown
Counsel memo on consumer, data and payment model	Before launch	Founders	Compliance gate fails
Supplier recruitment to 30 verified	Before catalogue freeze	Founders	Catalogue too thin to launch

Dependency	Needed by	Owner	Risk if late
Photography and content capacity	Before launch	Operations	Listings late or poor
Hosting and domain	Before build environment	CTO	Build blocked
Brand assets and domain clearance	Before public launch	Founders	Launch delay or rebrand

13. Business risks

The full register is RSK-01 to RSK-21 in the discovery report and the amendment. The business-critical risks are:

Risk	Business consequence	Mitigation	Owner
Scope sprawl across six departments	Late launch and shallow catalogue	Six bounded departments; week-8 scope gate	Founders
Supplier recruitment shortfall	No credible assortment	Dedicated recruitment; department quotas; onboarding incentives	Founders
Delivery failure rate	Trust collapse and refunds	Carrier qualification; zones; second attempt; measured promise	Operations
Return rate in fashion	Margin erosion	Size guides; fit reason codes; supplier scorecards; reserve	Category lead
Counterfeit or expired beauty	Legal and trust damage	Authenticity evidence; audits; delisting	Category lead
Baby safety incident	Liability and reputational harm	Declarations; recall checks; insurance; counsel	Founders
Payment or settlement error	Supplier distrust and loss	Ledger; daily reconciliation; maker-checker	Finance
Regulatory finding	Trading interruption	Counsel before launch; PSP structure; filings	Founders
Key-person dependency	Delivery stall	Documentation; second contributor; code access	CTO
Cash exhaustion	Stop before evidence	Lean scope; monthly burn review; stop rules	Founders

14. Governance, approvals and change control

14.1 Stage gates

Gate	Question	Evidence required	Approver
G0	Is the business worth building?	Concept, discovery, decisions	Founders
G1	Are the requirements agreed?	BRD and SRS signed off; open decisions assigned	Founders
G2	Is the design safe and buildable?	Architecture, data, API, security and UX approved	Founders and technical lead
G3	Is it ready to test?	Test plan, environments, test data, acceptance criteria	Technical lead and operations

Gate	Question	Evidence required	Approver
G4	Is it ready to launch?	Compliance memo, supplier cohort, carrier, PSP, runbooks	Founders
G5	Should it scale, pivot or stop?	Month-6 evidence pack	Founders

14.2 Change control

1. A change to scope is written, with the reason, the cost, the schedule effect and the risk.
2. The product owner assesses the impact against the traceability matrix.
3. The founders approve or reject at the next review; urgent safety changes may be approved by the duty manager and ratified within 48 hours.
4. Approved changes update the BRD, SRS and traceability matrix in the same version cycle.
5. No change is implemented by direct edit to code without a requirement and a test.

14.3 Sign-off

This BRD is approved when the founders confirm: the objectives and targets, the six-department boundary, the operating model, the business rules status, and the assignment of open decisions D-13 to D-20. Until then it remains a draft and does not authorize build.

15. Open items and next step

The blocking decisions D-01 to D-04 are closed. Eight sub-decisions remain:

ID	Question	Needed by
D-13	Exact six-department tree	BRD sign-off
D-14	Minimum basket or small-order fee	Checkout design freeze
D-15	Category commission schedule	Supplier contracts
D-16	Beauty authenticity evidence	Beauty go-live
D-17	Baby safety declaration	Baby go-live
D-18	Fashion return policy	Policy publication
D-19	Launch supplier cohort	Recruitment plan
D-20	Timeline fallback	Roadmap sign-off

The SRS will convert this BRD into numbered, testable requirements. The architecture, data, API and UX packs follow. No implementation begins until G2 is passed.

Appendix A. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Parent order	The customer’s single commercial order from one checkout
Supplier order	The part of a parent order fulfilled by one supplier; the settlement unit
Shipment	A parcel with a carrier, waybill and proof of delivery
Variant	A purchasable combination of options, such as size and colour, with its own SKU
GOV	Gross order value, the merchandise value of orders before deductions
Contribution	Revenue less commission costs, delivery costs, payment fees and expected returns
Mode A	Manual logistics coordination at pilot
Mode B	Integrated logistics through a carrier API
KYC	Know-your-supplier verification of identity, business and payout account
POD	Proof of delivery
PSP	Licensed payment service provider

Appendix B. Document map

Document	Purpose	Status
UM-DISC-001	Discovery baseline, evidence, rules, gaps	v0.2
UM-DEC-001	Decision log	v0.2
UM-AMD-001	Decision outcome and scope amendment	v1.0
UM-BRD-001	This document	v1.0
UM-SRS-001	Numbered software requirements	Next
Architecture pack	System, data, API and security design	After SRS
UX pack	Flows, wireframes, content and accessibility	After SRS
Test, DevOps, DR and roadmap	Delivery planning	After design